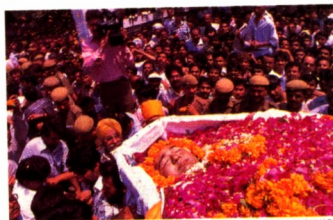




SHARAD SAXENA

38 BULLETS, ONE BODY

The cold-blooded murder of cassette king Gulshan Kumar on August 12 was a grim reminder of Bollywood's dangerous flirtation with the underworld. Allegedly shot for having refused to pay extortion money to the dons, on that fateful day, his Rs 350-crore empire came to nothing as gunmen pumped 38 bullets into his body.



PRAMOD PUSHKARNA

A NEW GODDESS

*"Her narrative crackles with riddles and yet tells its tale quite clearly," said Gillian Beer, chairwoman of the judges who awarded Arundhati Roy the Booker Prize for *The God of Small Things*.*



Mic-testing Times

In the 50th year of India's Independence, political debate took on another dimension altogether. In the Uttar Pradesh legislature, the symbolism of the microphone as a weapon was realised as politicians were unable to express themselves in words. With parliamentarians hurling not just abuse but also chairs at one another, India watched, disillusioned by the ungainly show.

ELSEWHERE...

APAP PHOTO



- Diana, Princess of Wales (above), was taken to a hospital after a car crash in the Pont de l'Alma road tunnel in Paris. She was pronounced dead at 4 a.m.
- The United Kingdom formally handed over Hong Kong to China.
- The last of China's major Maoist revolutionaries, Deng Xiaoping, died at the age of 92.
- In Roslin, Scotland, scientists announced the successful cloning of the first adult sheep, Dolly, who was born in July 1996.

1,057

people died through the year due to communal violence while another 197 died as a result of bomb blasts. Road accidents claimed another 50,975 lives, while over 350 were killed in more than 20,000 fires across the country.